

Quick-Start Guide: Policy Analyst / Government Official

Health Transformation Review (HTR) Platform

Your Role on HTR

As a policy analyst, Medicaid director, CMS staffer, or legislative analyst, HTR gives you:

- Structured analysis of federal and state health policy across all six pillars
 - Simulation tools for modeling policy scenarios and Medicaid eligibility rules
 - Comparative state data for benchmarking programs and proposals
 - AI-powered research assistant trained on healthcare policy content
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Step 1: Set Your Role

At `/welcome`, click "**Policy Analyst / Government Official**".

The AI Analyst will open with a prompt tailored to policy work — Medicaid waiver analysis, Vermont legislation, federal mandates, or a custom question.

Step 2: Your 5 Most Valuable Destinations

1. Policy Hub — `/policy`

The core intelligence layer for policy work. Sub-sections:

- **Regulation & Legislation** (`/policy/regulation`) — federal rule analysis, CMS rulemaking
- **Public Health Mandates** (`/policy/mandates`) — state and federal mandates
- **Global & Comparative Policy** (`/policy/global`) — international benchmarks
- **Policy Feasibility Studies** (`/policy/feasibility`) — what's politically and operationally achievable

2. Policy Simulator — `/research-lab/policy-quality?tab=policy`

Model the downstream effects of proposed legislation or rule changes. Adjust parameters — coverage rates, reimbursement levels, provider participation — and see projected outcomes across utilization, cost, and equity metrics.

3. Vermont Program Analysis

HTR has deep coverage of Vermont-specific programs:

- **Vermont Act 167** (`/vermont-act-167`) — 2022 healthcare transformation law + scenario simulator
- **Vermont Act 68** (`/vermont-act-68`) — 2025 continuation + simulator
- **Vermont Medicaid** (`/vermont-medicaid`) — eligibility rules, waiver status
- **Vermont RHT Program** (`/vermont-rht-program`) — Rural Health Transformation

4. Medicaid Eligibility Simulator — `/medicaid-eligibility-simulator`

Model Vermont Medicaid eligibility under different income, household, and categorical scenarios. Essential for waiver analysis and constituent casework.

5. 50-State Dashboard — /dashboard

Compare state Medicaid programs, hospital landscapes, and health outcomes across all 50 states. Use **Dashboard > Compare** (/dashboard/compare) for side-by-side state analysis.

Step 3: Key Workflows

Analyzing a Proposed Federal Rule

1. Search for the rule at /search (use rule number, e.g., "CMS-1234")
2. Read the HTR analysis in **Policy > Regulation**
3. Ask the AI: *"What are the second-order effects of [rule] on critical access hospitals?"*
4. Run the **Policy Simulator** to model impact on your state

Preparing a Legislative Brief

1. Use **AI Analyst** to draft a plain-language summary of the legislation
2. Pull comparative state data from the **50-State Dashboard**
3. Check **Policy Feasibility Studies** for precedents
4. Export key data points and save to **My Library** via bookmarks

Tracking Vermont-Specific Programs

1. Bookmark /vermont-act-167 and /vermont-act-68 as your starting points
2. Use the Act 167 Simulator to model how scenario changes affect program outcomes
3. Check **The Wire** (/the-wire) filtered for Vermont news
4. Ask the AI: *"What is the current status of Vermont's AHEAD Model participation?"*

State-to-State Benchmarking

1. Go to /dashboard/compare
2. Select Vermont and 2–3 comparison states
3. Compare Medicaid metrics, hospital capacity, program adoption
4. Export findings for your brief or report

Step 4: Research Lab Tools for Policy Work

Tool	Location	Use Case
Policy Simulator	/research-lab/policy-quality?tab=policy	Model rule/legislation impact
Work Requirements Calculator	?tab=medicaid-wr	Medicaid work requirement scenarios
H.R. 1 Cliff Scenario	?tab=hr1-cliff	Federal budget cliff analysis
HTA Studio	?tab=hta	Health technology assessment
Actuarial Lab	?tab=actuarial	Coverage and cost modeling
Global Budget Transition Modeler	/research-lab/payment-models?tab=gb-transition	State global budget modeling

Step 5: Community & Expert Access

- **HTR Connect > Ask HTR** (/connect/ask) — submit policy questions to HTR's expert team
- **Pillar Circles** (/connect/forums) — join the Policy pillar discussion forum

- **Office Hours** (/connect/register-office-hours) — live sessions with policy experts
 - **Policy Alerts** (/connect/alerts) — subscribe for real-time policy notification
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Getting Help

- **AI Analyst:** Your fastest research tool — ask in plain language
 - **Glossary:** /academy/glossary — authoritative definitions for policy and healthcare terms
 - **Medicaid Glossary:** /academy/medicaid/glossary
 - **Voice:** Press **⌘⇧V** for hands-free queries while reviewing documents
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